THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 07

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

Honesty is often described as the best policy, but it is not always the easiest one. A student who has not studied may feel tempted to copy. A shopkeeper who has been given extra change may be tempted to keep quiet. Such moments are small and pass quickly, yet it is in these moments that character is built.

A story is told of a young boy who found a purse on the road. It held more money than his family earned in a month. He walked to the address written inside and returned it to its owner. The owner offered him a reward, but the boy refused. 'I only did what was right,' he said. The old man later helped him with his schooling.

Honesty needs courage because the cost is paid at once while the reward comes late. The student who confesses that he copied an answer faces the teacher's displeasure today; the benefit of a clear conscience and the teacher's trust appears only later. For this reason small acts of honesty are a training of the will. One who returns excess change to a shopkeeper is slowly becoming a person who will not be bought in larger matters.

Honesty is also a kindness. A friend who tells us gently that our essay is weak does us more good than ten who praise it. Truthful feedback lets us improve; false praise leaves us to discover our faults in front of strangers. The best honesty, therefore, is neither rude nor boastful; it speaks the truth at the right time, in the right tone and for the right reason, which is to help.

Dishonesty, on the other hand, rarely stays alone. One lie needs a second to support it and a third to hide the second, until the liar spends more energy defending an untruth than he would have spent telling the truth. Sooner or later, the structure falls, and with it the trust that took years to build. Trust, once broken, is like a plate that has been mended: it may serve its purpose, but the crack is always visible. It is far wiser, and much lighter, to speak plainly from the start.

Honesty does not always bring a reward, and it should not be practised for one. Its real gift is peace of mind. A person who is honest has nothing to hide, nothing to remember and nothing to fear. Trust grows around such a person like a quiet shade tree.

(i) According to the writer, character is built in: 1

(a) large public events **(b)** exams only

(c) small moments of choice **(d)** holidays

(ii) The boy in the story found: 1

(a) a mobile phone **(b)** a purse full of money

(c) a bag of books **(d)** a watch

(iii) The boy refused the reward because he: 1

(a) disliked money **(b)** was rich
(c) was afraid **(d)** believed he had only done what was right

(iv) What did the old man later do? 1

(a) Helped him with schooling **(b)** Sent him away
(c) Hired him **(d)** Gave him a shop

(v) 'Trust grows around such a person like a quiet shade tree' is an example of a: 1

(a) alliteration **(b)** simile **(c)** metaphor **(d)** pun

(vi) Give one example of temptation mentioned in the passage. 1

(vii) How did the boy find the owner of the purse? 1

(viii) What is the real gift of honesty? 1

(ix) Find a word in the passage that means 'attracted to do something wrong'. 1

(x) Why does an honest person have nothing to fear? 1

(xi) The writer says small acts of honesty are: 1

(a) rarely rewarded **(b)** easy to perform
(c) a training of the will **(d)** a waste of time

(xii) Why is truthful feedback better than false praise? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

The bar chart in a school magazine showed the number of trees planted by four houses during a tree plantation week. Ashoka House planted 60 saplings, Beas House planted 45, Chambal House planted 75 and Dwarka House planted 30. The magazine editor, Rohit, noted that the plantation week was organised jointly by the Eco Club and the local Municipal Corporation, which supplied the saplings free of cost.

The saplings included neem, peepal, gulmohar and amla. The students dug the pits in the morning and planted the saplings in the afternoon after the soil had been softened by a shower. Each house was asked to adopt the trees it planted and to water them for the next six months. The house whose plants survive in the largest number will receive a rolling trophy at the Annual Day.

Rohit also wrote that the exercise taught the students responsibility. 'It is easy to plant a tree,' he wrote, 'but it takes patience to nurture it. A forest is built not in a day but through the daily work of many hands.' The Principal appreciated the effort and announced that a plaque would be placed near the garden, carrying the names of all the houses.

(i) Which house planted the most saplings? 1

(a) Chambal **(b)** Ashoka **(c)** Beas **(d)** Dwarka

(ii) Who supplied the saplings? 1

(a) The Principal **(b)** The Eco Club
(c) The Municipal Corporation **(d)** The parents

(iii) The houses must water the trees for the next: 1

(a) six months **(b)** one month **(c)** two years **(d)** one week

(iv) The winning house will receive: 1

(a) a cash prize **(b)** a holiday
(c) a certificate only **(d)** a rolling trophy

(v) How many saplings were planted by the four houses in all? 1

(vi) Name two types of saplings planted. 1

(vii) Why were the saplings planted in the afternoon? 1

(viii) What does the editor mean by 'a forest is built through the daily work of many hands'? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND